

TrueCost Platform Evolution: V1 vs V2

Comparative Analysis | May 09, 2026 | V1: borneo-2.vercel.app | V2: true-cost-main.vercel.app

V2 transforms TrueCost from informational calculator to emotional persuasion platform through cinematic storytelling, granular parameter control, and Malaysian-specific financial modeling. Core functionality remains intact while user engagement and configurability increase substantially.

1. Landing Page Experience

Aspect	V1	V2
Format	Static fact cards + scrolling tickers	Auto-play video + sequential text reveals
Narrative	Educational information grid	Story arc: 'You think' → 'Dealer shows' → 'Reality: 139% more'
Engagement	Passive reading	Active watching with tension/resolution
Example	Perodua Ativa table breakdown	Progressive icon reveal (■■■■■) with cost shock

2. Cost Calculation Engine Enhancements

- **Loan Controls:** Down payment slider (default 10%), tenure selection (5/7/9yr with auto-validation), interest rate override (2.5–5.0% flat)
- **Fuel Precision:** RON95 subsidy toggle (first 200L/mo @ RM2.05, excess @ RM4.02), traffic/driving/AC multipliers (1.0–1.25x), daily commute input vs static monthly km
- **Insurance/Maintenance:** 6-tier NCD ladder (0–55%), service center choice (Authorized 1.0x vs Independent 0.65x), brand retention depreciation
- **Location Reality:** Daily toll input, parking tiers (Free/Suburban/Town/City/KL-PJ/KLCC at RM0–400/mo) reflecting geographic cost variance

3. UI/UX & Information Architecture

Progressive Disclosure: V2 adds '■ How we calculated this' collapsible sections beneath each cost component (Loan/Fuel/Insurance/Road Tax/Maintenance/Depreciation). Shows formula + data sources + inputs used. Reduces cognitive load—novices see totals, advanced users drill into methodology. V1 presents all data at equal hierarchy. **Navigation:** Identical 6-step flow preserved (Overview→Finances→Car→Cost→Scenarios→AI). Export options (WhatsApp share, PDF report) unchanged.

4. Malaysian-Specific Financial Modeling

- **Fuel Subsidy Implementation:** Direct mapping of T15/B40 policy (200L monthly cap @ RM2.05, exceeding @ RM4.02)
- **PTPTN Integration:** Dedicated student loan repayment field (unique to Malaysia) in Step 2 financial profile
- **Regulatory Citations:** BNM/PIAM Motor Insurance Tariff, JPJ Road Tax Schedule 2024, KPDNHEP fuel prices
- **Geographic Stratification:** Parking tiers mirror KL/PJ/KLCC vs Suburban cost reality, brand depreciation classes reflect Malaysian used car market (Japanese retention dominance)

5. AI Features (Unchanged Architecture)

Step 3 Recommendations: '💎 Get AI Picks' button logic identical—matches user budget/DTI to inventory. **Step 6 Advisor:** '■ Generate Analysis' produces written report + conversational chat interface with quick questions ('Can I afford this car?', 'What are risks?', 'New vs used for me?'). V2 optimizes execution (response quality, latency) not capabilities—feature set stabilized in V1.

6. Wealth Gap Analysis (Preserved)

Step 5 unchanged: new-vs-used comparison, 5/10-year horizon toggle, 7% p.a. investment growth visualization. Architectural consistency indicates V1 achieved product-market fit—V2 innovates elsewhere.

7. Product Maturity Evolution Summary

Dimension	V1 State	V2 Advancement	Strategic Impact
User Engagement	Informational	Emotional narrative	Converts skeptics at top-of-funnel
Configurability	Fixed estimates	12+ adjustable inputs	Scenario modeling vs single calculation
Transparency	Results-only	Expandable methodology	Financial literacy tool vs black box

Localization	Currency/fields	Subsidy/PTPTN/geography	Malaysia-native vs adapted generic
Maturity Stage	Functional MVP	Production-ready	Scalable adoption readiness

Conclusion

V2 represents strategic repositioning from 'helpful calculator' to 'financial decision partner.' Cinematic landing experience addresses awareness gaps; granular parameter control enables sophisticated scenario modeling; Malaysian-specific features (subsidy, PTPTN, geographic pricing) demonstrate cultural grounding. Core strengths preserved (no-signup, 6-step flow, AI integration) while innovations target identified pain points (information asymmetry, configurability limits). Platform ready for scaled adoption in Malaysia's automotive finance ecosystem.